



South Dayton TOPSoccer

Domain Move — Step-by-Step Guide

Written for first-timers — no Cloudflare experience assumed.

This guide walks you through moving southdaytontopsoccer.com onto Cloudflare and pointing it at the new website, one click at a time. Do the parts **in order**. You do NOT need to understand how any of it works — just follow the steps. Where a button or link is named, it appears in **bold**.

Before you spend any money — read the deadline

Kris is shutting her server down ~**July 5, 2026**. The urgent goal is to get the domain off her server before then. Parts A–C below do that. The registration transfer (Part E) can finish later without taking the site down.

Plain-English glossary (skim once)

Domain — Your web address: southdaytontopsoccer.com.

Registrar — The company the domain is rented from. Right now that's Kris's platform; the goal is to move it to Cloudflare.

Nameservers — Two addresses that tell the internet who answers questions about your domain. Changing these is how you hand control to Cloudflare.

DNS record — One line in the domain's address book — e.g. “the website lives here,” “email goes there.”

Auth code (EPP code) — A one-time password that lets you move the domain to a new registrar. Only Kris can give it to you.

DNSSEC — An extra security lock. It must be turned OFF before changing nameservers, or the domain can break.

Zone — Cloudflare's word for “your domain and its records,” once added to your account.

Pages — The Cloudflare service already hosting your new site at south-dayton-topsoccer-website.pages.dev.

Apex vs. www — “Apex” is southdaytontopsoccer.com; “www” is www.southdaytontopsoccer.com. You'll connect both.

The big picture

Five parts. A through C get the live site onto the real domain (the urgent part). D keeps email working. E moves ownership of the domain to Cloudflare.

- **Part A:** Add the domain to Cloudflare and copy your two nameservers.
- **Part B:** Point the domain at Cloudflare (nameserver change — needs Kris or registrar login).
- **Part C:** Connect the website to the domain (Cloudflare Pages custom domain).
- **Part D:** Keep any @southdaytontopsoccer.com email working (Email Routing).
- **Part E:** Transfer the registration to Cloudflare so SDTSAdmin owns it (needs Kris's unlock + auth code).

What you'll need before you start

- The SDTSAdmin@gmail.com login (you'll use it for Cloudflare).
- A Cloudflare account signed in as SDTSAdmin (you already have one — the Pages site lives there).
- A debit/credit card on the Cloudflare account — the registrar transfer in Part E costs about **\$10-11 for one year, at cost** (no markup). Parts A-D are free.
- From Kris: the domain **unlocked**, the **auth/EPP code**, and her changing the **nameservers** (or giving you registrar login). A ready-to-send request to Kris is on the last page.

Part A — Add the domain to Cloudflare & get your nameservers

Time: ~10 minutes. Cost: free. This does not change anything live yet — it just sets Cloudflare up and gives you the two nameservers Part B needs.

1. Go to dash.cloudflare.com and sign in as SDTSAdmin@gmail.com.
2. In the left menu click **Domains** (or **Websites**), then click **Onboard a domain** (also labeled **Add a domain**).
3. Type southdaytontopsoccer.com (no “www,” no “https”) and click **Continue**.
4. Choose the **Free** plan (scroll down — it's at the bottom) and click **Continue**.
5. Cloudflare scans the current settings and shows a list of DNS records. Glance at it — you should see a row for the website and an **MX** row (that's email). **Don't delete anything**. Click **Continue**.
6. Cloudflare now shows **two nameservers**, each ending in [.ns.cloudflare.com](https://ns.cloudflare.com) (for example dana.ns.cloudflare.com and rob.ns.cloudflare.com). **Write both down exactly** — Part B needs them. (You can always find them again on the domain's **Overview** page.)

Where you are now

The domain is “added” to Cloudflare but still shows Pending — nothing has actually moved yet. That happens in Part B.

Part B — Point the domain at Cloudflare

This is the step that actually hands control to Cloudflare, and it's the one piece you may not be able to do yourself — the nameservers are changed wherever the domain is registered (Kris's platform). Two ways:

Option 1 — Ask Kris (simplest)

1. Send Kris the two nameservers from Part A and ask her to: (1) turn **off DNSSEC** if it's on, and (2) replace the current nameservers with the two Cloudflare ones, **copied exactly**. (The message on the last page says all this.)

Option 2 — Do it yourself (if Kris gives you registrar login)

2. Log in to the registrar. Find the setting called **Nameservers** (sometimes under “DNS” or “Advanced”).
3. Choose **Custom nameservers**, remove the existing ones (they contain hostingbusinesses.com), and paste the two [.ns.cloudflare.com](https://ns.cloudflare.com) values. Save.
4. If you see a **DNSSEC** or “DS record” setting that's turned on, turn it **off** first.

Then wait for “Active”

Within a few minutes to 24 hours, Cloudflare emails you and the domain's status flips from **Pending** to **Active** on the **Domains** page. **Do not start Part E until you see Active.**

Part C — Connect the website to the domain

Time: ~5 minutes once the domain is Active. This points southdaytontopsoccer.com at your existing Pages site and turns on the padlock (HTTPS) automatically.

1. In Cloudflare's left menu, click **Workers & Pages**.
2. Click your project, south-dayton-topsoccer-website.
3. Click the **Custom domains** tab, then **Set up a domain**.
4. Type southdaytontopsoccer.com and click **Continue**, then **Activate domain**. Cloudflare adds the needed record for you automatically.
5. Do it once more for the “www” version: **Set up a domain** → type www.southdaytontopsoccer.com → **Continue** → **Activate domain**.
6. Wait a few minutes for each to show **Active** (Cloudflare issues the SSL certificate behind the scenes). Then open <https://southdaytontopsoccer.com> — you should see the new site with a padlock.

Optional but nice: make [www](https://www.southdaytontopsoccer.com) automatically forward to the plain domain so there's one canonical address. In Cloudflare go to the domain → **Rules** → **Redirect Rules** and create a rule sending www.southdaytontopsoccer.com to <https://southdaytontopsoccer.com>. (Skip if unsure — both will work.)

Part D — Keep email working (only if needed)

The current setup routes @southdaytontopsoccer.com email through Kris's server, which is going away. If anyone actually uses an address like info@southdaytontopsoccer.com, set up free forwarding so it keeps arriving. **First ask Kris whether any such addresses are in use** — if none, skip this part.

1. In Cloudflare, open the domain and click **Email** → **Email Routing**, then **Add records and enable**.
2. Go to **Routing rules** → under **Custom addresses** click **Create address**.
3. Enter the address to keep (e.g. info@southdaytontopsoccer.com), and for **Destination** enter the Gmail it should forward to (e.g. SDTSAdmin's Gmail). Click **Save**.
4. Cloudflare emails that destination a confirmation — open it and click **Verify email address**.
5. If Cloudflare warns that old **MX** records exist and asks to remove them, say **yes** (that's the old mail server that's shutting down).

Part E — Transfer the registration to Cloudflare

This moves ownership of the domain itself to Cloudflare under SDTSAdmin, at cost (~\$10–11/yr). It can only be done **after** the domain shows **Active** (Part B). The site stays up the whole time.

1. At the registrar (ask Kris): **unlock** the domain and get the **auth/EPP code**.
2. In Cloudflare's left menu click **Domain Registration** → **Transfer Domains**.
3. Select southdaytontopsoccer.com and enter the **auth code**. (If it won't let you, the domain isn't **Active** yet — finish Part B first.)
4. Confirm the ~1-year charge and add a card if asked. Fill in the **contact info** (Cloudflare hides it from public WHOIS by default). Click **Confirm transfer**.
5. Watch for an email from the **current** registrar asking you to **approve** the transfer — approving it speeds things up. Otherwise it completes in about 5 business days (up to 10).

Gotchas & good-to-knows

- **Copy nameservers exactly.** One wrong character and the domain won't resolve.
- **60-day rule.** A domain can't be transferred if it was registered or transferred in the last 60 days. Yours is years old, so it should be fine — but if the transfer is rejected for this reason, that's why.
- **Approval email.** The transfer may need approval at the email on file for the domain (possibly Kris's). If it stalls, that's the first thing to check.
- **Order matters.** Cloudflare only lets you transfer the registration (Part E) after the domain is Active on Cloudflare (Part B). That's expected.

Fallback if Kris will only give the auth code (won't change nameservers)

Cloudflare requires the nameservers to be on Cloudflare before it will take the registration. If Kris won't change them and won't share login, transfer the domain to **Porkbun** or **Namecheap** first (they accept an auth code without a nameserver change), then point the nameservers to Cloudflare from there, and optionally move the registration to Cloudflare later.

Appendix — Message to Kris

Ready to send (via Jess, or have Jess forward). The real Cloudflare nameservers for this account are already filled in below.

Subject: South Dayton TOPSoccer — moving the domain to Cloudflare

Hi Kris,

Thank you again for all the years of help. We've moved the South Dayton TOPSoccer website to Cloudflare and now need to point the domain there too, under the program's own account. For southdaytontopsoccer.com, could you please help us with these:

1. Point the domain's nameservers to Cloudflare. Replace the current nameservers —
 ns1.hostingbusinesses.com
 ns2.hostingbusinesses.com
— with these two (copied exactly):
 pam.ns.cloudflare.com
 wesley.ns.cloudflare.com
2. If DNSSEC (sometimes shown as “DS records”) is on for the domain, please turn it off — otherwise the site can break when the nameservers change.
3. So we can also move the registration to the program's account, please unlock the domain for transfer and send us the EPP / authorization (auth) code.
4. Let us know the registrar the domain is registered through, and the registrant email address on file (so the transfer-approval message reaches us).
5. Lastly — are there any email addresses on @southdaytontopsoccer.com currently in use? We want to make sure we don't drop anyone's email when the server goes offline.

(Or, if it's easier for you, you're welcome to share registrar login and we'll make the nameserver/DNSSEC changes ourselves.)

We really appreciate it, and we hope Jim is healing well.

Thank you! ~Jess

Items 1–2 are what bring the new site live on the real domain (time-sensitive). Items 3–4 are for moving the registration afterward and aren't urgent.